WEEK 7 · LECTURE L3 · UNIT III

Implementation Architectures

Front line managers as the channel of HR, how practices diffuse, what hybrid work changes, and an Indian model of leadership.

R K Singh · Senior Professor, Department of Commerce · Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Explain why front line managers decide how HR is experienced.
- Apply diffusion of innovations to an engagement rollout.
- Evaluate the evidence on telecommuting and hybrid work.
- Apply Sinha's nurturant task leader to the choice of champions.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 2 (apply engagement strategies) and CLO 5 (create programs for hybrid workforces).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

A good policy will spread on its own once people see that it works.

Agree or disagree.

THEORY IN DEPTH · PURCELL AND HUTCHINSON (2007)

Front line managers bring policy to life

THE CORE IDEA

Employees experience HR through their line manager's behavior, not through the policy document.

HOW IT WORKS

Leadership behavior and the way managers enact HR practices shape commitment and discretionary effort.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Case based evidence from a set of firms; direction of effects is not proven.

IN PRACTICE

Two plant supervisors apply the same recognition policy; one team values it, the other never notices it.

EXAM LENS

Use it to argue that implementation runs through managers. Pair with Kehoe and Wright (2013) on perceived practices.

PERCEIVED PRACTICES · KEHOE AND WRIGHT (2013)

What employees perceive is what counts

THE FINDING

Employees' perceptions of high performance practices related to commitment, citizenship and intention to stay.

THE IMPLICATION

Designed practices matter only as far as employees perceive them.

HOW PRACTICES SPREAD · ROGERS (2003)

Diffusion of innovations

Adopter group	Share	Role in an engagement rollout
Innovators	2.5 percent	Volunteer pilots
Early adopters	13.5 percent	Opinion leaders and champions
Early majority	34 percent	Follow visible success
Late majority	34 percent	Follow norms
Laggards	16 percent	Resist; may hold real concerns

EXAM LENS

Choose champions from early adopters with standing, and treat laggard concerns as information.

THEORY IN DEPTH · GAJENDRAN AND HARRISON (2007)

What telecommuting does

THE CORE IDEA

Telecommuting had small positive effects on autonomy, satisfaction and performance.

HOW IT WORKS

It had no general harm to workplace relationships, but high intensity telecommuting, over 2.5 days a week, harmed coworker relationships.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Studies came before widespread hybrid work; effects may differ when everyone is remote at once.

IN PRACTICE

A firm moves engineers to four remote days; output holds but peer help and mentoring fall.

EXAM LENS

Use it to show hybrid work trades autonomy for coworker relationships. Design deliberate contact.

AN INDIAN FRAME · SINHA (1980)

The nurturant task leader

THE MODEL

A leader who is task oriented and nurturing, offering care that is conditional on effort.

THE IMPLICATION

Champions in Indian workplaces may need to be respected seniors, not only enthusiasts.

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Three routes to implementation

Route	Mechanism	Risk
Through line managers	Daily behavior carries the policy	Uneven manager capability
Through champions	Social proof from early adopters	Champions lack authority
Through structure	Systems and rules enforce use	Compliance without belief

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"HR policy is only as good as the line manager who implements it." Critically evaluate. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses Purcell and Hutchinson and Kehoe and Wright; links to Bowen and Ostroff; proposes how to build manager capability.

Plan the rollout of an engagement initiative in an Indian manufacturing firm using diffusion theory. **20 marks**

A strong answer: applies adopter groups; chooses champions with care, using Sinha; addresses resistance; sets measures.

What did Gajendran and Harrison find about telecommuting? **10 marks**

A strong answer: benefits for autonomy and satisfaction; cost to coworker relationships at high intensity.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Employees experience HR through their manager
2. Practices spread through early adopters, not by themselves
3. Hybrid work buys autonomy at some cost to coworker ties

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Saks, A. M. (2006). Antecedents and consequences of employee engagement. *Journal of Managerial Psychology, 21*(7), 600–619.

Macey, W. H., Schneider, B., Barbera, K. M., & Young, S. A. (2009). *Employee engagement: Tools for analysis, practice, and competitive advantage*. Wiley Blackwell. Chapters 1 to 2.

People Matters and SHRM India: a selected case on an Indian engagement transformation (Wipro, Infosys or HCLTech), as listed in the Lesson Plan.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 7 set readings. They support the implementation choices in this lecture.

THEORY SOURCES · FOR REFERENCE

Sources for this lecture (1 of 2)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Gajendran, R. S., & Harrison, D. A. (2007). The good, the bad, and the unknown about telecommuting: Meta analysis of psychological mediators and individual consequences. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 92*(6), 1524–1541. https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.92.6.1524

Kehoe, R. R., & Wright, P. M. (2013). The impact of high performance human resource practices on employees' attitudes and behaviors. *Journal of Management, 39*(2), 366–391. https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206310365901

Purcell, J., & Hutchinson, S. (2007). Front line managers as agents in the HRM performance causal chain: Theory, analysis and evidence. *Human Resource Management Journal, 17*(1), 3–20. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1748-8583.2007.00022.x

Sources for this lecture (2 of 2)

Rogers, E. M. (2003). *Diffusion of innovations* (5th ed.). Free Press.

Sinha, J. B. P. (1980). *The nurturant task leader: A model of the effective executive*. Concept.